

bulk of their money via cable operators and they can't afford to not support cable.

It was in 2012 that Sky and BT Vision, two of UK's largest cable networks, bought the rights to air three seasons of the Premier League matches for the sum of £3,000,000,000 (that's ₹300,490,000,000,000)! Think about that for a second, a 116 games, two million potential viewers per game and three billion pounds.

Staggering as that sum is, what's more staggering is that if you break down the math you discover that each viewer is worth more than ₹50,000 a year in ad revenue (the number of people who watch the matches, not the actual user base, which is much higher) during the Premier League. There is literally no way that anyone other than the zaniest of the zany rich will be able to afford an ad-free version of said matches. Of course, some of the cost will also be recovered via overseas licensing deals as well, but that's still a lot of money spent.

Taking the example of ESPN, (which is, by the way, the Most Valuable Media Property in the USA) it earned an average of ₹300 per home per month from the 100 million+ households that subscribe to the channel. When you consider the fact that you probably pay about ₹600-₹1,000 a month for access to 500+ worthless channels, that's actually quite cheap.

You're not getting access to content as and when you want it, you're not even getting content that's offering the same quality that you want, but at least you're getting content, and at a bargain.

The bandwidth argument

Many feel that the best way to really get what you want, when you want it is via the Internet. This makes sense because we pirate what we want anyway, and it's not like the Digital Natives even imagine any other avenue for entertainment at this scale. Sadly, research has found that by



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the year 2015, we will be consuming, on average, 33.5Gb of data per person per day (TV, music, Internet, text, voice calls, et al.). Roughly translated, this means that we, as a race, consume 13hrs of multimedia content daily (if it were all video).

Why are we telling you this? Engineers involved in the TV industry claim that this is the primary reason they can't give you all the content you want online, there's simply not enough bandwidth. Without going too much into the technical details, what they're basically saying is that the network infrastructure that keeps the Internet up and running is simply incapable of carrying all this data to the users and that cable is still the most efficient way of bringing that data to the masses; whether you like it or not.

The argument seems very valid, but when you really think about it, gen z probably never watches TV anyway and they're perfectly fine with the bandwidth situation as it exists right now (the Comcast vs. Netflix case is way beyond

the scope of this article and is mostly irrelevant here). In fact, stats bear this out, clearly indicating that the age group of people watching TV is steadily going up and that young 'uns are leaving by the droves. Though it's more likely that they're not leaving and are probably just ignoring TV.

One could however, very accurately, claim that India still doesn't have enough Internet penetration to handle a DTH/cable-free TV experience and no matter what else we try, that we have no other option for a long time yet.

Live TV

The long-held bastion of television has always been live broadcasts, be it news or sports. If there is one thing that's wrong with the on-demand future that we envision, it has to be the inability of pushing live content to the viewer. Or so we're led to believe.

If you really think about it, how many events in a day are truly news worthy?

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